How Clear Is Your Picture of Who Covers What for Dad?

Twelve quick questions about what you know. At the end: what you've confirmed, what's still open, and who to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how complete your own picture is. It doesn't measure Dad or the people who help him, and nothing you answer here means his care is falling short.

1. Do you have a written list of what Dad needs help with?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Do you have the current care plan and the agency's schedule in writing, with their dates?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Do you know what each scheduled visit is meant to cover?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. For each need on your list, do you know who is supposed to cover it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Do you know which parts of the help someone in the family has seen happen, and which you're taking from the paperwork?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Do you know everything your sister, or whoever fills in, does for Dad in a usual week?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Have you asked her how she's managing it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Have you heard from Dad, in his own words, how the help is going?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Does your list include company, getting out and the things Dad enjoys, as well as the practical tasks?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Have you written down the places where two people, or a person and a paper, say different things?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Have you set aside any questions about his health or his medications for his doctor or nurse?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. For each open item, do you know who could answer it and who in the family will ask?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what you know, not how Dad or his care is doing. A low count means there are things to find out, and most of them are a phone call or a visit away. A “no” or a “not sure” is a line to check, not a sign that anything has gone wrong.

Ready for the next step?

You can see which parts of Dad's care you've confirmed and which you're still taking on faith. The care interview goes through his situation area by area and records who covers each part, then turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›